Karim Elsarha

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager

Strategic Supply Chain & Infrastructure Procurement Leader

18+ years turning negotiation, compliance, and data into measurable results. I lead procurement, inventory planning, and infrastructure projects across Egypt's port and economic-zone sector.

- Nationality: Egyptian
- Available to join within one month
- Open to relocation (KSA/GCC)



About

A Career Built on Trust, Numbers & Negotiation



Karim Elsarha

SCZONE · Cairo, Egypt

Procurement & Inventory Planning professional with 18+ years of experience across Egypt's public port and economic-zone sector. My work rests on structured negotiation, contract governance, and data-based decisions, and I bring that approach to every partnership, negotiation, and cross-functional project I lead.

I care about turning operations into clear systems, whether a procurement cycle, a supplier relationship, or a warehouse process, and I'm always looking for the next challenge where that discipline adds real value.

18+
Years of Experience

35%
Procurement Cost Savings (up to)

800+
Suppliers Onboarded

25
Team Members Led

Experience

A Track Record Across the Full Supply Chain

Procurement & Inventory Planning Manager

Jan 2025 – Present

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt

60%	35%	80%	65%	55%
↓ Bid Cycle Time	↓ Procurement Cost (up to)	↓ Approval Delays	↑ On-Time Delivery	↓ Excess Inventory

- ✓ Keeps procurement and inventory operations compliant with FIDIC conditions, legal frameworks, and governance requirements.
- ✓ Automated RFQ/RFP workflows in SAP MM, cutting bid cycle time by 60% and reducing manual processing errors by 80%.
- ✓ Leads supplier negotiations on payment terms and pricing, reducing procurement costs by up to 35% without disrupting supply continuity.
- ✓ Improved supplier on-time delivery by 65% through a performance scorecard linked to contract renewals and continuous improvement programs.
- ✓ Deployed AI-assisted demand forecasting and real-time inventory tracking that cut excess inventory by 55% and raised order fulfillment accuracy to 98%.
- ✓ Feeds inventory and demand data into S&OP discussions.
- ✓ Co-authored SCZONE's Procurement & Contracts Regulations as part of a 5-member team. The regulations were approved and remain in effect.
- ✓ Manages high-value contracts end-to-end, including regulatory risk and contract disputes.
- ✓ Led the SAP MM implementation: knowledge transfer, staff training, documentation, and SCZONE's representation in project meetings.
- ✓ Works closely with legal and finance teams to clear contract approvals faster, cutting delays by 80%.
- ✓ Runs Distribution Requirements Planning (DRP) across multiple sites using Min-Max levels, ABC classification, and demand forecasting to balance stock availability and holding costs.
- ✓ Built a web application (Python, Flask, SQLite) to replace the manual Excel and Power Query workflow for tracking employee custody items (issue, return, addition).
- ✓ Drafted the Warehouse Regulation (13 chapters plus appendices, based on Egyptian government references and international standards, including ISO 55000 and CIPS), now in legal review ahead of approval.
- ✓ Leads, coaches, and develops a team of 25 professionals.

Procurement & Inventory Control Section Head

May 2016 – Jan 2025

Suez Canal Economic Zone (SCZONE) — Cairo, Egypt

800+	19%
Suppliers Onboarded	Disqualified for Underperformance

- ✓ Managed the full procurement cycle, including RFQ, ITB, and RFP processes, and monitored bid compliance throughout the bid lifecycle.
- ✓ Onboarded 800+ suppliers through an evaluation system and disqualified 19% of them for underperformance.
- ✓ Oversaw day-to-day warehouse operations: inventory control, stock management, and distribution workflows.
- ✓ Evaluated supplier quotes and proposals on price, delivery terms, and service offerings.
- ✓ Conducted market research to identify sourcing opportunities, benchmark pricing, and align bid strategies with current market conditions.
- ✓ Introduced barcode tracking for warehouse operations, which improved inventory accuracy.

Budgeting & Cost Accountant

Jun 2008 – May 2016

Red Sea Ports Authority (RSPA) — Suez, Egypt

- ✓ Collected, analyzed, and reported operational cost data to support management decision-making and cost control.
- ✓ Helped prepare and consolidate RSPA's annual budget and multi-year financial forecasts.
- ✓ Collaborated with department heads to gather budget inputs and align them with organizational strategy.
- ✓ Assessed the financial impact of changes in goods and services on overall operational costs.
- ✓ Monitored budget performance through the fiscal year, identified variances, and recommended corrective actions.

This is where my budgeting, feasibility-study, and financial-evaluation instincts were formed.

Case Studies

Projects I'm Proud Of

A closer look at how I handle high-stakes problems from start to finish.

Infrastructure Project

Vessel Traffic System (VTS) Navigation Tower, Ain Sokhna Port

THE CHALLENGE

A greenfield, highly technical maritime navigation project, with no existing specifications or in-house technical expertise to build from.

Approach

- ✓ Mapped the technical and operational risks from the ground up and built a standard reference model for the project.
- ✓ Formed a cost-neutral partnership with the Suez Canal Authority to bring in specialized maritime expertise.
- ✓ Co-developed precise tender documents aligned with international maritime standards.

Results & Impact

- ★ Awarded the contract below comparable market rates, while securing the latest available technology.
- ★ Delivered full procurement, installation, and commissioning within a tight 7–8 month timeline.
- ★ Measurably improved maritime safety, operational throughput, and real-time tracking across the port.

Strategic Planning

Enterprise Inventory Control & Strategic Planning — SCZONE

THE SCOPE

Full ownership of inventory planning, reorder thresholds, and asset control across multiple ports and economic hubs.

Approach

- ✓ Set dynamic Min/Max reorder points to prevent stockouts and free up working capital tied in excess stock.
- ✓ Catalogued, photographed, and condition-assessed terminal telecom and IT equipment for full audit transparency.
- ✓ Ran multi-year trend analysis on operational supplies to guide smarter resource allocation.

Why It Matters

- ★ Built the same asset-verification discipline that underpins credible financial and operational audits.
- ★ Turned scattered inventory data into a governed, audit-ready system across every site.
- ★ Reinforced the financial discipline needed for accurate budgeting and feasibility work.

Individual Initiative

Warehouse & Custody System Automation

THE CHALLENGE

Custody records were kept on paper and in scattered Excel files. Finding an employee's custody items or processing a return meant searching file by file.

Approach

- ✓ Started by consolidating the records into one database with Excel Power Query, Power BI, and Access, searchable by employee name.
- ✓ Then built a web application (Python, Flask, SQLite) to replace the manual Excel and Power Query workflow for tracking employee custody items (issue, return, addition).
- ✓ Structured the system around two core functions: personal custody tracking and returns processing.

Impact

- ★ In use at SCZONE by the staff responsible for custody records and returns.
- ★ Replaced file-by-file searches with instant lookup by employee name.
- ★ Built individually, with no external vendor or system integrator.

Individual Initiative

Warehouse Regulations Framework

THE CHALLENGE

SCZONE had no formal warehouse regulation. Inventory and custody procedures relied on informal practice instead of a documented framework.

Approach

- ✓ Benchmarked reference frameworks, including those of the Ministry of Communications, the Financial Regulatory Authority, West Delta Electricity, and the government's standard warehouse regulations.
- ✓ Drafted the full Warehouse Regulation: 13 chapters plus appendices, based on Egyptian government references and international standards, including ISO 55000 and CIPS. Used AI tools to speed up research and drafting.
- ✓ Now in legal review ahead of formal approval.

Status & Impact

- ★ Once approved, it will be SCZONE's first documented warehouse regulation.
- ★ Prepared individually, without external consultancy support.
- ★ Reflects the same regulatory drafting and benchmarking discipline that goes into any large-scale governance framework.

Team Project · 5 Members

Procurement & Contracts Regulations

THE CHALLENGE

I was part of a 5-person team that built SCZONE's unified procurement and contracts regulations.

Approach

- ✓ Each team member reviewed the procurement regulations of a reference organization and extracted the clauses that best fit SCZONE's operations.
- ✓ The team consolidated the findings in a joint working session and merged the best-fit provisions into one framework.
- ✓ Co-authored the first draft of the unified regulations with the team.

Results & Impact

- ★ Formally approved and still in effect at SCZONE.
- ★ Gave the department a single, consistent reference for procurement decisions instead of scattered practices.
- ★ Built cross-team consensus-building and drafting skills directly transferable to any multi-party negotiation.

Entrepreneurship

NOGA Café: Entrepreneurship

THE SCOPE

A café venture where I built the business plan and the operating setup, from feasibility to procurement and inventory.

Approach

- ✓ Built the business model, operating concept, and financial feasibility study.
- ✓ Built CAPEX, OPEX, pricing, break-even, and scenario-planning models.
- ✓ Set up the procurement, inventory, and demand-planning processes.

Results & Impact

- ★ Produced an integrated business model covering the commercial, operational, and financial sides.
- ★ Set up a data-based foundation for demand forecasting and inventory decisions.

Core Competencies

Skills & Competencies

Negotiation & Stakeholder Relations

- Strategic Negotiation
- Long-Term Relationship Building
- Cross-Functional Collaboration
- Commercial Evaluation & RFP Management
- Tendering (RFQ/ITB/RFP)

Contracts, Trade & Compliance

- Contract Drafting, Review & Follow-Up
- FIDIC / USAID Compliance
- International Trade & Letters of Credit (LCs)
- Official Correspondence & Memo Drafting
- Contract Management
- Green Procurement

Financial & Strategic Analysis

- Budget Planning & Management
- Feasibility Studies & Market Research
- Investor Evaluation Frameworks
- Strategic Planning

Inventory, Technology & AI

- SAP MM & Demand Forecasting
- Safety Stock Planning & Annual Audits
- Power BI & Advanced Excel / PowerPoint
- AI-Assisted Supplier Evaluation & Data Analysis

Additional Projects

More Work Across the Procurement Lifecycle

General Procurement Projects

End-to-end procurement of vehicles, IT equipment, office furniture, and critical spare parts.

Infrastructure Upgrade Projects

Procurement and coordination for major infrastructure works: the Ain Sokhna Port VTS navigation tower (in partnership with the Suez Canal Authority, under a below-market contract, delivered in 7 to 8 months), the Adabiya Port development, and a complete sewage-station installation.

Security & Safety Systems Projects

Sourcing and implementation of fire-suppression networks, explosive-detection devices, and investor communication systems.

International Import Projects

Cross-border procurement of navigational devices (Vissim, Norway), marine spare parts (Mapso, Switzerland), and a natural gas station unit (Pietro Fiorentini, Italy), including regulatory compliance and customs clearance.

Consultancy & Technical Studies Projects

Collaboration with global consultants on Ain Sokhna Port environmental studies, and procurement supervision for the Port Said Quays development program.

Education & Certifications

Continuous Learning, Purposefully Applied

Education

Master's Degree in Supply Chain Management

Arab Academy for Science, Technology & Maritime Transport (AASTMT) · In Progress, expected August 2027

Coursework: Strategic Planning, Operations, Lean Six Sigma, Quality Control

Bachelor's Degree in Commerce (Accounting)

Suez University, Egypt

Associate Degree in Management Information Systems

Suez Higher Institute for Management Information Systems, Egypt

Certifications

- **PMP, Project Management Professional**
  PMI · In Progress
- **LinkedIn Learning (course completions)**
  Become a Supply Chain Manager · Negotiation Skills · Project Management Foundations (Procurement) · Inventory Management Foundations

Training & International Exposure

Representing Egypt on the International Stage

Industrial Transformation & Economic Development Seminar

AIBO / China Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM) — Beijing, China | Jul–Aug 2024

Selected as part of the official Egyptian delegation under China's Global Development Initiative at the New Industrialization Conference, with first-hand exposure to international economic-development and investment-promotion dialogue.

Behavioral Barriers

National Center for Training and Leadership (NCTL), Egypt · 2022

Anti-Corruption Training

National Anti-Corruption Academy, Egypt · 2022

Contact

Let's Connect

Open to new opportunities in procurement, supply chain, and inventory leadership, in Egypt or internationally.

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New Cairo, Egypt

Available to join within one month · Open to relocation (KSA/GCC)

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